Rail Pass Break-Even Worksheet

Pass price I checked today:

Date I checked it and where (official site):

Which pass type and how many days:

Journey 1, price of the single ticket I checked:

Journey 2, price of the single ticket I checked:

Journey 3, price of the single ticket I checked:

Journey 4, price of the single ticket I checked:

Journey 5, price of the single ticket I checked:

Journey 6, price of the single ticket I checked:

Total of single tickets:

Pass price minus total:

Reserved seats I want, and whether they cost extra on the pass:

Activation date I would choose, and why:

My rule: if the total of single tickets is clearly higher than the pass price, I lean towards the pass. If it is lower or close, I buy single tickets. My decision:

Use only prices you have checked yourself on the official rail sites. Pass rules, eligibility and prices change, so check again before you buy.

Booking Countdown

- [ ] Many months out: choose the season and the trip length
- [ ] Many months out: agree the budget and the travel party
- [ ] Many months out: check passport validity and entry rules on the official site
- [ ] Many months out: book flights, and lodging for busy periods
- [ ] Several months out: book the traditional inn night and fixed-date tickets
- [ ] Several months out: check booking-release dates for popular places
- [ ] A few months out: decide on a rail pass using the break-even sheet
- [ ] A few months out: travel insurance, and a talk with my doctor
- [ ] About 2 months out: phone, data plan and bank card plan
- [ ] About 1 month out: pack list started, shoes tested on a long walk
- [ ] About 2 weeks out: forwarding service and airport transport checked
- [ ] Last week: documents, cash, copies, charger, hotel cards

No dates are given because they differ by place and year. Check each booking site for its own release rules and cancellation terms.